



“Our presence across the energy value chain ensures that we don’t just produce power but are also responsible for taking it to the end consumer”

PRAVEER SINHA
CEO & MD, TATA POWER



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SAMIR SEKSARIA
CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER, TCS

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most visible when it comes to electric vehicles. Here, the company has put in place the ecosystem, including charging stations, to increase its adoption. It has also laid emphasis on manufacturing key components locally and developing supporting infrastructure.

TURNING IT AROUND

In the case of Tata Power, one experience altered the way it functioned. “Based on our experience in turning around the power distribution company (discom) in Delhi, we acquired all four discoms in Odisha in 2021. In just three years of operation, they have gone from ailing to profitable enterprises,” says Sinha. Now, through the company’s solar rooftop offerings and electric mobility chargers, it wants to promote sus-

tainable energy choices.

Meanwhile, Tata Steel, which went through its own share of challenges in foreign markets, has doubled down on India. Koushik Chatterjee, ED & CFO of Tata Steel, says there’s no downplaying the external challenges facing the industry today “are unprecedented”.

Chatterjee highlights issues like the tapering of construction demand in China, which has led to a surge in exports, and the conflicts in eastern Europe and the Middle East disrupting supply chains and pushing up prices. The current fiscal year is one of significant change for the company. “It is a transition year for Tata Steel UK as it exits its legacy loss-making blast furnace operations accompanied by a 30% reduction in our workforce.” Hence the thrust on

India, one of the fastest-growing markets for steel.

“Recently, we commissioned one of the world’s largest blast furnaces in Kalinganagar and consciously rebalanced our portfolio through two acquisitions in long-products,” says Chatterjee.

Tata Steel also went the inorganic route to acquire Bhushan Steel and then Neelachal Ispat. The latter was acquired through the government’s disinvestment process.

Being the first-mover on green steel, the company could alter the story dramatically, especially in Europe. “By 2030, 60% of what we produce there will be low CO2 emissions and ready to face regulatory and market changes,” says Chatterjee.

Vipul Prasad, Founder and CEO of Magadh Capital Advisors, is bullish on Tata Steel because of its focus on sustainability, cost leadership, and top-notch capital allocation, apart from the plans to tweak its geographical mix. “They have also continued to plug gaps in the product mix as well as the production process with enhanced technology and digital application,” he explains.

Clearly, technology will be a key enabler, and TCS’ Seksaria says AI, cybersecurity, and sustainability are all technological evolutions “that are rewriting the future of industries”. From his company’s point of view, he says, “We are at the crossroads of not just another technology cycle but a critical juncture in the whole of human evolution. The upsides are humongous, as are the ethical risks involved.”

For a group that was started in 1868, and that makes everything from salt to software, the future beckons! **BT**

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